

C01 HEALTH AND WELL-BEING PROMOTION | P

Intent : Promote a deeper occupant understanding of the WELL features pursued by the project or organization and how building design, operations and policies impact health and well-being.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to provide a guide to occupants that highlights the WELL features pursued by the project, the relationship between health and buildings and available health resources and programs.

Issue : Health literacy refers to a person's cognitive and social ability to access, interpret and understand basic health information, as well as the ability to act on that understanding to maintain health.¹⁻⁴ Health literacy is influenced by sociocultural factors, such as age, socioeconomic status, mental health, cultural background, language and communication abilities, prior health experiences and how healthcare delivery and education systems deliver care, health information and health education.¹ Low health literacy is linked to lower use of preventive care (e.g., flu shots), poor management of chronic conditions (e.g., high blood pressure) and lower self-reported mental and physical health.^{5,6} Studies estimate that low health literacy costs the U.S. economy anywhere between \$70-240 billion each year.^{5,7}

Solutions : Multi-modal programming, educational materials and communications can help promote health literacy and increase positive health outcomes.^{8,9} By supporting awareness of health and wellness programs and policies, projects can promote health literacy and encourage engagement with health resources, leading to both individual benefits - like increased participation in healthy behaviors and use of health services - and also employer benefits, providing an estimated 4:1 return on investment.^{5,10}

PART 1 PROVIDE WELL FEATURE GUIDE

For All Spaces:

1: WELL feature guide

A physical or digital WELL feature guide, such as the WELL report, will be prominently displayed and/or made widely available to all occupants upon certification achievement or completion of a review cycle, meeting the following requirements:

- a. Describes the WELL features achieved by the project or organization.

2: Communications

The following requirement is met:

- a. Quarterly communications (e.g., emails, modules, trainings) are sent to regular occupants, and onboarding communications are given to new employees (as applicable), about health resources, programs, amenities and policies available to them addressed by the WELL features achieved by the project or organization.

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